



| Q&A WITH SIDDHARTH ZARABI |

“INDIA HAS SET THE GOLD STANDARD FOR A G20 PRESIDENCY”

I&B Secretary Apurva Chandra decodes the impact of India’s one-year presidency of the G20

AHEAD OF THE 18TH

G20 Heads of State and Government Summit in New Delhi on September 9-10, Apurva Chandra, Secretary in the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (I&B), tells *Business Today* how the one-year G20 presidency has helped the country bolster its image in the global arena, what it has to offer to the world, and the benchmark India has set. Edited excerpts:

▶▶▶

What has India’s presidency at the G20 meant and what has been achieved through this one year?

The G20 summit is the culmination of the efforts of the past one year. India has held various meetings of the working groups as well as the engagement groups. More than 50 cities, [and] almost all the states have been covered, and many delegates have come to India. A lot of deliberations have taken place on various issues.

India has some things to contribute to the world. On the economic side, take for example digital public infrastructure (DPI). It is one of the biggest achievements [of the

country]... in India billions of transactions take place seamlessly through DPI. This infrastructure is led by the public sector and through the support of the government, while in many other countries, even if such infrastructure is made, it is through private enterprise. And it is open architecture where everybody can join in. It is hugely empowering, and

a credible, stable and democratic nation been enhanced as a result of the G20 presidency?

India has pushed a broad agenda of what we have done to showcase it to the world. And, I’m sure many of these things will form a part of the communiqué—the leaders’ declaration—when it happens on September 10. We are not privy to what the declara-

consequent economic issues have been felt across the world. What can be expected as far as restoring a sense of order globally is concerned?

India’s position has been very clear and Prime Minister Narendra Modi has articulated it clearly that this is not the time for war. This is a position that India takes at all multilateral forums.

THE G20 PRESIDENCY HAS HELPED SHOWCASE MAKE IN INDIA... WHEREVER MEETINGS WERE HELD, THERE WERE SIDE EVENTS THAT SHOWCASED THE PROGRAMME

this is something we are contributing to the world.

I think it is an effort of nine years [and] now the entire world is recognising that India has taken the lead. We are now the fifth-largest economy, and three to four years down the line we will be the third-largest economy. The entire world is taking note of these achievements.

▶▶▶

Has India’s voice as

tion will be as of now, but once it comes out, we will see the stamp of India. And once this declaration comes out, it becomes an agenda for all the countries to follow to implement over the next few years. So it is not just a question of one year. It is a continuous agenda that all the countries will follow. And that’s an important point.

▶▶▶

The ongoing conflict and

This statement of our Prime Minister has been repeated by many other world leaders as well and shows the statesmanship of our Prime Minister.

▶▶▶

What can be expected in terms of trying to set the global agenda, including in the space of financial stability and development?

I think just a few days ago, there was a meeting